

Open questions in the governing documents

Places where these documents are ambiguous, silent, or behind what the Team actually does. Found by encoding Articles 10 and 20 as executable rules in github.com/candy-dance/candy-dance-app — a computer cannot apply a rule that says two contradictory things, so it surfaces the contradictions a careful human reader would resolve by judgement and move past.

Read this before amending anything; several items propose replacement wording. `CHANGELOG.md` records what has actually been adopted.

Started 2026-08-15.

Encoding the bylaws as executable rules surfaced places where the text can't be mechanically applied without picking an interpretation. Each item below says what the code does in the meantime and, where useful, proposes replacement wording. Most of it does not block the build — but items 1 and 2 are decisions only the Co-Directors can make, and the code has `TODO` comments pointing back here.

Item 9 has a clock on it. It records a live departure from the bylaws, taken deliberately and with an audit trail, that expires within thirty days. It should be ratified or ended at the next Leadership Team meeting rather than being allowed to lapse quietly and then be re-taken.

1. Article 10.3 says two contradictory things — blocking for automation

Current text:

Nonpayment. If dues are not paid within **one (1) week after** the due date, the participant's spot **may be forfeited** and removal from the Project is **automatic**.

"May be forfeited" is permissive — someone decides. "Removal from the Project is automatic" is mandatory — nobody decides. A human reading this resolves it by judgment. Software cannot: it either removes people or it doesn't.

The two readings also disagree about Article 15. Under the discretionary reading, removal is a decision and Article 15.3's single appeal plausibly applies. Under the automatic reading, there is no decision to appeal, and Article 15.2 routes nonpayment dismissal to Article 10 — which then never says who, if anyone, may reverse it.

What the system does now: flags the condition in the officer dashboard and emails the participant, and never changes anyone's status. Safe under either reading, since flagging is a subset of both. See `supabase/migrations/0005_views.sql`.

Proposed replacement, discretionary reading (matches how the system is built, and matches Article 15's general preference for human decisions):

Nonpayment. If dues are not paid within **one (1) week after** the due date, the participant's spot may be forfeited. The Co-Directors will decide whether to remove the participant from the Project, and will notify them in writing. Article 15.3's appeal right applies to that decision.

Proposed replacement, automatic reading (if the intent really is no case-by-case judgment):

Nonpayment. If dues are not paid within **one (1) week after** the due date, the participant is removed from the Project automatically. The Co-Directors may reinstate a participant who pays or arranges payment. No appeal under Article 15.3 applies, as no discretionary decision is made.

If you pick the automatic reading, tell me — the system would need to actually set `members.status = 'forfeited'`, which today it deliberately never does.

2. Article 10.5 defers hardship accommodations, but the system has a waiver field

Current text:

Future adjustments. The Leadership Team may adopt sliding scale or hardship accommodations in the future if funds allow.

This authorises *adopting a policy later*; it does not grant the power to reduce dues today.

It is already happening. The Open Floor 2026 tracker shows Andy Pham and Jessica at \$80 against a \$160 dancer assessment — a 50% hardship reduction, granted and collected, under an Article that says the Team *may* adopt such accommodations in the future. That is 2 of 10 participants, and per the Co-Directors more people needed hardship on this project than expected. This is no longer a theoretical gap in the drafting; the bylaws are behind the practice.

A related trap in the tracker. The single Subsidized? (50% off) column was also marking Brooklyn Castillo and Cat Tang, who were the Project Choreographers for Open Floor 2026 and so pay the Article 10.1 half rate. Two unrelated rules under one flag, and — worse than it first appears — indistinguishable at *any* rehearsal count, because the choreographer rate is exactly half the dancer rate and so a 50% hardship dancer always lands on the same figure.

That means the conflation could never have been caught by checking totals. It becomes visible only when the Team needs a hardship percentage other than 50%, or when a choreographer also needs hardship — at which point one column cannot represent the answer. The system keeps `role` and `subsidy_percent` as separate fields for that reason, and a test asserts a choreographer on 50% hardship pays a quarter of the dancer rate.

What the system does now: `subsidy_percent` on the dues row, `waived` status for a full waiver, and a required reason on both. Plan 7 goes further and builds a full request-and-approval workflow: a member asks for a percentage at signup with a reason, and at least one Co-Director approves or denies it.

This is the item to fix first. Everything else in this document is drafting tidiness. Here the system now has a formal approval process, an approver requirement, and outbound email, for a power Article 10.5 explicitly frames as not yet adopted. The Team's own choices — at least one Co-Director, no one decides their own — are recorded in `supabase/migrations/0013_signup_and_hardship.sql`, but they are conventions in code, not rules in the bylaws.

Proposed replacement for Article 10.5:

Hardship and sliding scale. A participant may request a reduction in their dues for a Project, stating the reason. A request is approved or denied by at least one Co-Director, who may approve a reduction smaller than the one requested. No person may decide their own request. While a request is pending, the participant is not subject to the nonpayment provisions of Section 3. Each request and decision is recorded in the Team's system and reported in the Treasurer's monthly report under Article 11.6.

The pending-request sentence matters as much as the approval rule: without it, a participant who asks for help is technically forfeitable while waiting on the Co-Directors to answer.

Proposed replacement, if the Leadership Team is willing to adopt the policy now rather than "in the future":

Hardship and sliding scale. The Treasurer may reduce or waive a participant's dues for a Project on hardship grounds, with the approval of both Co-Directors. Each reduction or waiver is recorded in the Team's system with the reason and is reported in the Treasurer's monthly report under Article 11.6.

The two-Co-Director approval mirrors the conflict controls in Article 11.7, and routing it through the monthly report keeps it visible without a new process.

2b. A waiver and a 100% hardship reduction reach the same \$0 under different rules

Following on from item 2. The system has two ways to bring an assessment to zero, and they are governed inconsistently.

What the system does now:

- Setting `dues.status = 'waived'` requires a **Co-Director**, enforced by trigger since migration 0018.
- Setting `dues.subsidy_percent = 100` requires only an **officer**, and produces the same \$0.

The first rule was added on the reasoning that excusing money should not rest with the person recording it. That is sound as a principle. It is not, however, what Article 10.5 says — 10.5 reserves hardship to nobody, and Article 9.2 makes anything not reserved to the Co-Directors ordinary Leadership Team business. So the stricter of the two rules is the one with no basis in the text, and the looser one is arguably correct.

Why it has been left as it is: loosening a control on money is a Leadership decision, not something to change quietly in a migration. Both rules are recorded and enforced; what is missing is agreement on which one is right.

What the Leadership Team needs to decide: whether excusing dues — by either route — is ordinary Leadership business under 9.2, or should be reserved to the Co-Directors. Then either relax the waiver guard or extend it to large hardship reductions, and say so in Article 10.

Every reduction is now logged with who set it and what it moved from and to (`subsidy_changes`), so whichever way this goes, the history is attributable.

3. Article 10 doesn't contemplate partial payment

Article 10.3 turns on whether "dues are not paid". A participant who has paid \$150 of \$200 by the deadline is neither clearly paid nor clearly unpaid, and the system has to put them somewhere.

What the system does now: treats partial as unpaid for forfeiture purposes — the flag only clears when the full amount is covered. This is the conservative reading, and it means a partial payer gets a warning email rather than silently sitting in limbo.

Suggested addition to Article 10:

Partial payment. Dues are considered paid only when paid in full. A participant who has paid part of their dues by the date in Section 3 is treated as unpaid for purposes of that Section, but the Treasurer will ordinarily contact them before any forfeiture decision.

Low priority — the current behaviour is defensible without an amendment. Worth folding in next time Article 10 is opened for another reason.

3b. Three practices in the tracker that Article 10 does not mention at all

Found by reconciling the system against "Copy of Open Floor 2026". None of these block the build — each is implemented and cited to the tracker rather than to a bylaw — but Article 10 currently describes a simpler world than the one the Team operates in.

Try before you buy. The Co-Directors made the first two rehearsals a trial: a participant pays only for the trial rehearsals they actually attend, and owes nothing further unless they commit. Kial Tran attended one and paid \$20; Rilla attended none and paid nothing. Article 10.1 has no concept of this — it assumes everyone owes the full scheduled count from the start.

Installment plans. Seven of ten participants were on one. Article 10.2 contemplates a single due date and Article 10.3 a single forfeiture date, so a participant who meets their plan is nonetheless "unpaid" past

the Article 10.3 date on a literal reading. Brooklyn Castillo is exactly this case: she met the 07/05 project deadline with her first \$40 and fell behind on an installment due 08/02.

Charges beyond dues. The tracker has an **Extras Owed** column and four blank **Extra Rehearsal? Yes** rows. Article 10 provides no mechanism to charge a participant anything other than dues, so who owes an extra rehearsal — everyone on the project, or only those who attend — has no answer in the governing documents. The system makes the officer choose per charge rather than guessing.

Suggested addition to Article 10, covering all three without over-specifying:

Alternative arrangements. The Co-Directors may, for a Project, set a trial period during which a participant pays only for the rehearsals they attend; approve an installment plan for a participant, in which case the dates in that plan replace the dates in Sections 2 and 3 for that participant; and approve charges for optional additional rehearsals or activities, payable only by the participants who take part unless the Co-Directors state otherwise. Each arrangement is recorded in the Team's system.

The clause about installment dates replacing Sections 2 and 3 is the load-bearing one. Without it, everybody on a plan is technically forfeitable from the eighth day, which is plainly not what anyone intends.

7. Article 10.1 states the dues rate as a figure, not a default

Current text:

Project-based dues formula. Dues are set per Project as follows:

- **Dancers:** (Number of scheduled rehearsals) × **\$20**
- **Project Choreographer(s)/Artistic Director(s):** (Number of scheduled rehearsals) × **\$10**

Those numbers exist to cover studio rent. *Heroes & Villains* (August 2026) has no studio cost, so the Co-Directors set it at **\$10 per rehearsal**, with choreographers at \$5. That is obviously reasonable and equally obviously not what Article 10.1 says.

What the system does now: `projects.dancer_rate_cents`, defaulting to Article 10.1's \$20. Choreographers pay half of whatever it is — the *relationship* in 10.1 is preserved, only the base moves. A CHECK keeps the rate even so the half is always whole cents.

Proposed replacement for Article 10.1:

Project-based dues formula. Dues are set per Project as (number of scheduled rehearsals) × a per-rehearsal rate determined by the Co-Directors, which will not exceed **\$20** for dancers absent a written exception. Project Choreographer(s)/Artistic Director(s) pay **half** the dancer rate. In setting the rate the Co-Directors will have regard to the Project's studio and production costs.

The ceiling keeps 10.1's protective intent — participants cannot be charged arbitrarily — while letting a Project without studio costs charge less. The half-rate relationship is stated once rather than as two figures that can drift apart.

8. Article 11.9 says read-only, and the system lets Co-Directors write

Current text:

The Treasurer will provide reasonable **read-only** access to financial reports/records to the Co-Directors and Secretary for oversight and continuity.

Read strictly, only the Treasurer may record a payment. The Team decided that is too tight: nobody could enter a payment while the Treasurer was away, and Article 7.8's interim-officer appointment is slower than that problem.

What the system does now:

	Read payments	Record payments	Refund	Waive
Treasurer	yes	yes	yes	no
Co-Directors	yes	yes	yes	yes
Secretary	yes	no	no	no

The Secretary half of 11.9 is enforced exactly as written — she has full read access and cannot change an amount. The Co-Director half is deliberately wider.

Waivers are withheld from the Treasurer on purpose: recording money received and excusing money owed are different decisions, and Article 11.7's principle that nobody approves their own applies by analogy.

Every change to a payment, refund or waiver is recorded in an append-only log with who made it and the previous value.

Proposed replacement for Article 11.9:

Access to financial records. The Treasurer maintains the Team's financial records. The Co-Directors may record payments received when the Treasurer is unavailable. The Secretary and each Co-Director have read-only access to all financial reports and records for oversight and continuity. Every change to a financial record is logged with the identity of the person making it.

9. The Treasurer is acting under delegated authority where the bylaws name a Co-Director

The situation: the Team's two Co-Directors are also this Project's choreographers and the two people whose dues were comped. Decisions the bylaws assign to them — waivers, and approving people who sign themselves up — were queuing behind the people they concerned.

What the system does now: an officer may take on **time-boxed delegated authority** (`officer_delegations`). It requires a written reason, runs for a maximum of thirty days, and expires by itself. Every act taken under it is appended to `delegated_action_log`, which is append-only by trigger and not writable by anyone through the app, including the person it implicates. Acts taken by an actual Co-Director are not logged — the record is for the exception.

Self-authorisation is permitted and recorded as such: `granted_by` is stored separately from `granted_to` and surfaced in the app as "self-authorised, nobody else approved this".

Why: a rule nobody present can satisfy gets worked around outside the system, where there is no record at all. That is worse than a rule bent inside it. But this reasoning holds for weeks, not indefinitely.

What the Leadership Team needs to do: ratify this at a meeting (Article 9.1), or amend the bylaws to describe it. A possible amendment:

Temporary delegation. Where these bylaws require Co-Director approval and no Co-Director is available or is disinterested in the matter, an officer may act for a stated period not exceeding thirty (30) days, recording the reason. Every action so taken will be recorded and reported at the next Leadership Team meeting.

Note the phrase "*or is disinterested in the matter*" — the situation that prompted this was not absence but conflict of interest, and an amendment that only covers absence would not cover it.

4. Article 7.1(b) good standing is now computable — an opportunity, not a problem

Current text:

a "member in good standing" is an individual who: ... b) is not currently suspended/removed and **has satisfied any current financial obligations to the Team.**

Once dues live in this system, "has satisfied any current financial obligations" stops being a judgment call and becomes a query: no dues rows past their due date with status **unpaid** or **partial**. That matters because good standing gates voting eligibility (Article 7.2), candidacy (7.3), and tie-break votes (9.4) — and the Secretary currently maintains that roster by hand (Article 6.3).

Nothing needs to change in the bylaws. Flagging it because the November election under Article 7.4 needs an eligible-voter list, and the data to generate one will exist. A `members_in_good_standing` view is a small addition whenever you want it; it isn't in the current plans because Article 7.1(a) also requires participation in two Projects in twelve months, which needs the attendance module.

5. Article 12.1 — record Stripe as the approved platform

Current text:

Dues collection. Dues should be collected through a payment platform approved by the Co-Directors.

The Article is written to survive platform changes, which is right. But there's no record anywhere of *which* platform is currently approved, and the approval is a Co-Director decision the bylaws require.

Suggested: no bylaw change. Record the approval once — a line in `admin/governance/leadership_roster.md` or a dated Leadership Team note — saying the Co-Directors approved Stripe under Article 12.1 as of the launch date.

Three operational points that go with it, none needing an amendment but all worth getting right at setup (Plan 2 Task 7 Step 5 walks through them):

- **Payouts must go to the Team's SFCU business checking account.** Article 12.1 forbids processing through the personal account of any participant or officer, and `finance_reimbursement_policy.md` section 2 already names SFCU. A Stripe account wired to someone's personal checking breaches this regardless of who forwards the money afterwards.
- **Both Co-Directors need Stripe admin access,** per `admin/governance/account_data_access_policy.md` section 3. Stripe and the Supabase project are now core platforms in the sense that policy means, and neither is listed there yet — see item 6 below.
- **Whoever administers Stripe should be an authorized signer** under Article 11.2 (the two Co-Directors and the Treasurer).

5a. Article 12.1 covers the bank account but not the tax identity

Current text:

Dues collection. Dues should be collected through a payment platform approved by the Co-Directors ... provided that payments are processed through the Team's account(s) and not through personal accounts of any participant or officer.

This correctly protects where the money *lands*. It says nothing about whose tax identity the merchant account is opened under, and that is the part with teeth.

Stripe onboarding asks for a business type and a tax ID. The path of least resistance, when one officer is clicking through it alone, is *Individual / Sole proprietor* — at which point **Stripe issues the 1099-K to**

that officer personally, and roughly \$980 of dues per Project is reported to the IRS as their income. Article 12.1 would still be satisfied on its face, because the payouts land in the Team's Stanford Federal Credit Union account. The officer would nonetheless be untangling it on their own tax return.

CAN.dy is an unincorporated association with an EIN and a business checking account in the Team's name ([bank_resolution.md](#)), so the correct setup exists — it just has to be chosen deliberately.

Suggested addition to Article 12:

Account identity. Any payment platform used to collect dues will be registered in the name of CAN.dy Dance Project under the Team's Employer Identification Number, not under the personal tax identity of any officer or participant, and will pay out to a Team account. Both Co-Directors and the Treasurer will hold administrative access.

The administrative-access sentence restates [admin/governance/account_data_access_policy.md](#) §3 where it will actually be read — at setup time — and mirrors the three authorized signers in [bank_resolution.md](#).

5c. Dues are being collected by Venmo and Zelle, which Article 12.2 says to avoid

Current text:

12.2 No peer-to-peer payments. CAN.dy will avoid peer-to-peer payment services for Team transactions when feasible.

The Team currently collects dues by **Venmo, cash, and Zelle**. Venmo and Zelle are peer-to-peer services, so the practice sits against 12.2's stated intent — though 12.2 says "when feasible", and before this system there was arguably no feasible alternative.

Two things follow, and the second is the sharper one:

"When feasible" changes once Stripe exists. 12.2 is a soft constraint by design, but the moment there is a working card-payment path the feasibility argument weakens. Worth a deliberate Leadership Team decision rather than drift — including whether to keep Venmo/Zelle deliberately, since not everyone wants to hand card details to a dance team.

Whose Venmo and whose Zelle? Article 12.1 requires payments be processed through the Team's accounts and *not* through the personal account of any participant or officer. If dues have been landing in an officer's personal Venmo or a personal Zelle, that is squarely what 12.1 prohibits, regardless of the money being forwarded on afterwards — and it carries the same 1099-K exposure described in item 5a, because Venmo issues those against the receiving individual.

Worth checking, not assuming: are the Venmo and Zelle destinations registered to CAN.dy Dance Project against the EIN and the SFCU account, or to a person? If a person, that is the highest-priority item in this document, above even the Article 10.5 ratification.

What the system does now: `payments.method` records the actual rail — `stripe`, `venmo`, `zelle`, `cash`, `check`, `other` — rather than collapsing everything non-Stripe into "manual". A `peer_to_peer_payments` view flags the Venmo and Zelle share, so 12.2 can be judged against a number instead of an impression.

5b. Gross receipts are not bank deposits

Stripe deducts its fee before paying out — roughly 2.9% plus 30¢ per transaction. On Open Floor 2026's \$940 that is about \$30 that never reaches SFCU.

This is not a bylaws problem, but it is a **reporting** one, and Article 11.6 requires the Treasurer to report balances to the Leadership Team. A report saying "collected \$940" against a bank statement showing roughly \$910 invites the Treasurer to go looking for a discrepancy that does not exist.

What the system does now: `payments.fee_cents` is captured from Stripe's balance transaction, `net_cents` is generated from it, and the monthly summary shows gross collected, fees, and the amount that reached SFCU as three separate figures — with a banner saying plainly that none of them is a surplus, because studio rent has not been deducted either.

Dues themselves settle on the **gross** amount. A member who pays \$160 owes nothing further; the fee is a Team expense. Passing it on would mean charging \$164.64 for a \$160 assessment, which contradicts Article 10.1's exact formula and would need an amendment to do properly.

6. WildApricot references are now stale in six files

Commit 76fe129 removed WildApricot from the bylaws, but it remains in:

File	Lines
README.md	15, 33
AGENTS.md	19, 36, 37
admin/README.md	20, 36
admin/operations/records/drive_conventions.md	9, 38, 41
admin/operations/projects/rehearsal_tracker.md	7, 9, 79
admin/governance/account_data_access_policy.md	6, 10

Two of these need care rather than find-and-replace:

- **account_data_access_policy.md:10** requires both Co-Directors to have admin access to "core platforms (WildApricot + all social channels)". That requirement should transfer to the new system and to Stripe, not just get deleted — it's a real control. The equivalent here is `is_officer = true` on both Co-Directors' member records plus admin access to the Stripe account and the Supabase project.
- **rehearsal_tracker.md** is built entirely around WildApricot event fields. It shouldn't be rewritten until the attendance module exists and there's something to map onto; rewriting it now would be inventing a schema.

The rest are navigation text that can be updated whenever. I'd hold all of it until the app is actually in use — the docs should describe what the Team does, and until launch that's still WildApricot.

Not an issue: Article 20 is unusually well-drafted for this

Worth saying explicitly, since everything above is a complaint. Article 20 maps onto working code with no interpretation needed: 20.1 gives the checkbox legal effect, 20.2 requires records name a specific version, 20.3 requires append-only retention, 20.4 authorises electronic notice. Each became a concrete constraint in `supabase/migrations/0004_documents_and_acknowledgments.sql` — including the append-only triggers, which exist because 20.3 says "not altered or deleted" rather than "should not normally be altered".

One correction to the build spec rather than the bylaws: the spec cited "Article 15.4" as authority for reminder emails. Article 15 is *Discipline, dismissal, and appeal* and has three sections. The correct citation is **Article 20.4**, and that's what the code uses.